

A KEEPER'S HANDBOOK

Emberclutch: Skyreach Valley, the player's guide (version 1.0)

EMBERCLUTCH

SKYREACH VALLEY



Made by Noah Hicks · free and open source · for the Nintendo 3DS

WELCOME TO SKYREACH VALLEY

Skyreach Valley is a green bowl of a valley ringed by lilac mountains, with a waterfall, a lake, a market village and a few islands floating in its sky. Dragons live here alongside the people, and every dragon has a keeper. Now one of them is you.

Emberclutch is a dragon life game for the Nintendo 3DS. You choose an egg, keep it warm until it hatches, and raise the hatchling into a grown dragon over a week or so of real days. You care for it with the stylus, walk it through the valley on its lead, ride it into the sky once it's grown, and, if you like, train it into a champion of battles and beauty shows.

A few promises before you start:

- **Nothing ever dies.** A dragon you forget about gets lonely and sulks. It never gets ill, never runs away and never loses what it has learned. You make up, and you carry on.
- **It lives in real time.** The game follows your 3DS clock. Your dragon gets hungry while you're at school or work, sleeps when it's night where you are, and grows a little every day.
- **Short visits are enough.** A few minutes a day keeps a dragon happy. Longer sessions are for the valley, the league, the shows and the long walks.

Emberclutch was made by Noah Hicks, for Emi, who makes every day feel like hatching day. It's free, open source and fan-made: nothing in it costs money, ever.

GETTING STARTED

INSTALLING

You need a 3DS (any model, the original included) with custom firmware such as Luma3DS.

- **Universal Updater:** search for *Emberclutch* and install it.
- **FBI and a QR code:** in FBI choose *Remote Install*, then *Scan QR Code*, and scan the code on the release page.
- **By hand:** copy `emberclutch.cia` to your SD card and install it with FBI, or copy `emberclutch.3dsx` into `sdmc:/3ds/` and start it from the Homebrew Launcher.

Sound needs your 3DS's DSP firmware (`sdmc:/3ds/dspfirm.cdc` , made once with the DSP1 tool). Without it the game runs, silently.

Your save lives in `sdmc:/3ds/emberclutch/` . The game keeps two copies and writes them in turn, so a save that gets interrupted never loses both. Photos you take go in the `photos` folder beside them.

THE TWO SCREENS

Short tips pop up the first time something new comes along (the settings can show them again). The **top screen** shows the world: your den, the valley, a battle or a show. Slide the 3D slider up for depth (or turn the 3D off in the settings). The **bottom screen** is where your hands are: the care tray, the needs, buttons, the map and the Journal.

THE CONTROLS

Stylus	Pet, brush, feed, bathe and play; buttons, the map, the Journal
Circle Pad	Walk; in the den, look around
A	Whatever's near: talk, go in, light a lantern, climb on; flap when flying
B	Hold to run; dive when flying
L and R	Turn the view. Flying: R bursts ahead, L brakes
X	The Journal in the valley; in the den, an outing
START	The system menu: settings, the Dragondex, save and quit

YOUR EGG

Every keeper starts with one egg, chosen from three:

Egg	Hatches into	Element
A warm orange one	the Pouncer , quick and curious, always ready to pounce	Ember
A mossy green one	the Puffback , a walking hill of moss and flowers	Grove
A sandy grey one	the Curlstone , slow, steady and kind	Stone

None is a wrong choice: every kind can do everything in the game, each in its own way.



Warming the egg in the den's nest

An egg needs only one thing: **warmth**. Rub it with the stylus to warm it. While it's warm it grows, and once it has been warm for **a day and a half** it hatches. Let it cool and it simply waits for you. Turn it gently now and then too: the dragon inside likes the attention, and it hatches already a little fond of you. Near the end you'll hear it knock.

When it hatches you meet your dragon for the first time and give it a name (a suggestion is already filled in, and you can rename it later). You'll also find out whether it's male or female, and which **colouring** it has: every kind comes in four, and one of the four is rare.



Hatching day

THE NEEDS

Need	What fills it	How fast it fades
Belly	Food from the tray (its favourite food fills half again as much)	Quickly awake, slower asleep
Clean	A bath	Slowly: a bath every two days or so
Play	Toys and games, walks, challenges	Steadily while it's awake
Love	Petting and brushing	Steadily while it's awake; a Shy dragon holds on to it longer
Energy	Sleep	Games, challenges and battles tire it out

The care tray: food, a brush, a sponge and toys

THE TRAY

The **tray** on the bottom screen holds everything you care with. Pick something up and the dragon reacts to exactly where you use it:

- **Pet** it by stroking with the stylus. Head scratches, chin rubs and belly rubs each get their own reaction, and its heartglow pulses under your hand. Every dragon has a **sweet spot** it loves scratched most: find it, and its profile remembers.
- **Feed** it by dragging food to its mouth. Every dragon has a favourite food and wiggles for it.
- **Brush** it to fill its Love and shine it up, and **bathe** it when it's grubby: dust settles on a dragon over a day or two, and it comes home muddy from the Wanderings. Brushing lifts mud slowly; a bath takes everything off at once.
- **Play** with toys: toss a ball, dangle a feather, have a tug.

THE HEARTGLOW AND MOODS

Every dragon has an ember of light in its chest, its **heartglow**, and it shows how the dragon feels. Its mood comes from its needs, with the lowest need counting extra:

Mood	How it shows
Joyful	Bright, quick sparks. It follows you about and does its best at everything
Content	A steady glow
Restless	A flicker. It paces and fidgets
Sulky	Dim. It sighs and lies down
Upset	Dim and turned away. It sits in the den's corner and won't play or compete

A dragon gets **upset** if it stays sulky for a whole day, or if three days go by without a visit. It's never hurt by it. To **make up**, go to it gently, offer its favourite food, and pet it until its heartglow lights again. Bond only grows again once you've made up.

BOND, MANNERS AND TRAITS

Bond is how much your dragon trusts you, and it grows with every bit of care, every walk and every competition. It doesn't fade: a dragon remembers.

Every dragon has a **manner**, one of ten (Brave, Shy, Playful, Proud, Sleepy, Curious, Gentle, Mischievous, Greedy or Stubborn). A manner colours how it behaves and nudges one stat up and one a little down (the almanac has them all). It's never a bad roll.

It also has **traits**: one or two (three on a rare colouring), from *Swift* to *Tidy* to *Night Owl*, listed on its profile. Each does one small thing (a Tidy dragon stays clean longer, a Swift one flies faster), and some are rare: the almanac at the back of this book lists them all.

Tap the heartglow on the bottom screen to open its **profile**: its kind and colouring, manner, traits, level, stats, moves and record.

CARE STARS AND GROWING UP

At the end of each day your dragon earns up to **three care stars**, judged by how well its needs were kept through the day (a day without a visit earns one star at most). Stars and days together grow it up:

Stage	Days since hatching	Care stars	What it brings
Hatchling	from hatching		Care, toys, its first walks
Juvenile	1½ days	3	Bigger and bolder; the Wanderings
Adolescent	3¼ days	7	Nearly grown
Grown	5½ days	12	Riding and flying; breeding

With near-perfect care a dragon is grown in five and a half days; with patchy care it takes longer, but it never shrinks back. It changes a little every day in between: head and eyes smaller, neck, tail, horns and wings longer, from cute to majestic.

THE DEN



The den

The den is a cave in the cliff beside the waterfall, and it's home. Up to **three dragons** can live in the den at a time, with **two nests** for eggs. More dragons rest at the **Sanctuary Meadow**, where the keepers look after them (their needs never drop below half, and they don't grow while they're there), and spare eggs keep in the **Cold Vault** (up to fifty), where they wait without hatching. Swap who's at home whenever you like.

- **Decorating:** the den has spots for a rug, a lantern, a perch, a plant and a banner, filled from what you find and buy.
- **Photos:** photo mode holds the den still for a picture and saves it to your SD card.
- **The mailbox** by the door gets letters from the valley's people now and then. A new letter shows on the mailbox.
- **The settings (START):** the music, the sounds and the voices, the 3D, the tips again, your look, and starting over.

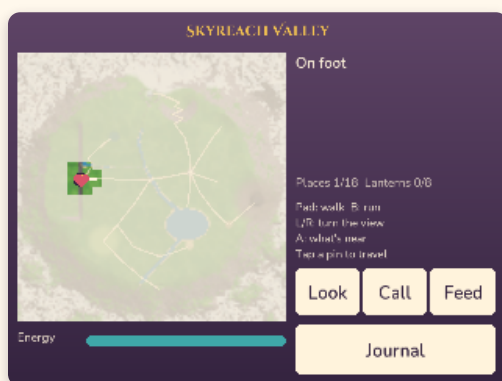
THE VALLEY



Out in the valley

Press **X** in the den for an **outing**: make a dragon your travel partner, then head out into **Skyreach Valley** with it on its lead. Walk with the Circle Pad, hold **B** to run, and turn the view with **L** and **R**. Walks raise bond, Love and Play, and make a dragon hungry a little sooner. **A** does whatever's near you: talk to someone, go in, light a lantern.

THE MAP



The valley's map on the bottom screen

The bottom screen shows the valley's map. Places you've found are pins: **tap one to travel there at once**, and the den's pin takes you home. The fog lifts from the map as you explore. From the start you'll know the way to the Market

Village, the Nesting Stone, the Sanctuary Meadow, the Cold Vault, the Wanderers' Trailhead, the Arena and the Floating Isles; there are others to find.

DAY AND NIGHT

The valley's light follows your 3DS clock: morning mist, bright noon, golden evenings and starry nights. Some people keep their own hours, and some things only happen at one time of day.

PEOPLE AND THE JOURNAL

The valley's villagers have their own lives, and some of them will ask for your help. Everything you've been asked to do goes in the **Journal** (press **X**). Tap a flag in the Journal to **track** a goal: the map then shows where to go with a gold marker, or a soft circle when it's somewhere to search. Something's afoot in the valley, too: the **Lantern Festival** is coming, and the lanterns need lighting. Stand by a dark lantern, press **A**, and your dragon breathes it alight.

FINDS, GLEAM AND THE MARKET

Little treasures turn up about the valley every day, glinting in the grass: the **day's finds**. **Gleam** is the valley's money (dragons love anything shiny), and you earn it from finds, challenges, battles, shows and the Wanderings.

Spend it at the **Market Village**: food, goods that change every day, and an **egg of the day**. Market eggs are labelled male or female, so you can find your dragon a partner on purpose. L and R move between the stalls.

RIDING AND FLYING



Flying over the valley

Once your dragon is **grown**, walk up to it in the valley and press **A** to climb on.

- On the ground: walk and run as on foot. **A** takes off.
- In the air: **A** flaps, climbing with every wingbeat. **B** dives. Let go of both to glide. Steer with the Circle Pad; **R** bursts ahead and **L** brakes.
- Land by flying low over the ground, then press **Down** to get off.

Flapping and bursting spend your dragon's **stamina**, shown while you fly; gliding and diving let it come back. The air thins up high, so there's a ceiling to how far you can climb. A dragon's **Wing** makes it faster and nimbler in the air, and its **Stamina** lets it fly longer. Every kind flies its own way: quick and darting, slow and steady, or gliding for miles.

Some places in the valley can only be reached with wings.

STATS AND GROWING STRONGER

Every dragon has five **stats**, from its kind and its own potential, grown by training and levels:



A dragon's stats and moves on its profile

Stat	Out and about	In a battle
Wing	Speed and agility in the air	Who goes first
Wit	Cleverness and tricks	Hitting, dodging and critical hits
Might	Strength	The power of body moves
Breath	The power of its element's breath	The power of breath moves
Stamina	Endurance: flying, playing, working	Health

Challenges and battles bring **experience**, and every **level** adds to the stats (see them on the profile). In Skyreach Valley a dragon can reach **level 42**.

THE ELEMENTS

Each kind belongs to an **element**, and a crossbreed to two. Elements colour the heartglow, lean a dragon's favourite food, decide its breath, and matter a lot in battles. There are eight: **Ember**, **Grove**, **Stone**, **Gale**, **Tide**, **Frost**, **Lumen** and **Shade**.

BATTLES: THE RULES



A battle in the valley

Battles are friendly duels, one dragon each, turn by turn. The valley's challengers stand about waiting for a match; walk up and talk to them.

A turn: each side picks one of its **four moves**. The faster dragon (more **Wing**) usually goes first, though a few quick moves always go first. A move can miss; Wit helps a dragon hit and dodge, and now and then a hit lands as a **critical hit**.

Moves come in three sorts:

- **Body moves:** tackles, swipes and pounces, powered by Might. Most have no element; each element also has one body move of its own.
- **Breath moves**, in the dragon's element, powered by Breath.
- **Stat moves**, which raise your dragon's stats or lower the other's (up to two steps either way), or let it catch its breath and heal (once a battle).

The very strongest moves need a breather: they can't be used two turns running. A dragon learns new moves as it levels up; choose its four on its profile.

The elements' wheel. Each element is strong against the next, doing **double damage**, and does only half to the one that beats it:

Ember melts Frost · Frost cracks Stone · Stone stops Gale · Gale strips Grove · Grove drinks Tide · Tide douses Ember

Lumen and Shade stand apart from the wheel, each strong against the other. Against a dragon of two elements, both count.

Winning: a dragon whose health runs out is **tired out**, and the other wins. Nobody is ever hurt: a tired-out dragon just lies down for a rest. If a battle runs long, the one with more health left after forty turns wins. You can give up at any time. Battles cost Energy, so a worn-out dragon needs a sleep before its next.

The league. The battle league has four ranks: **Ember**, **Flame**, **Blaze** and **Starfire**. Each has four challengers about the valley; beat all four and the rank's champion waits for you at **Emberpeak Caldera**. Win the final and the rank is yours, with a title for your dragon and the next rank's challengers arriving. The league's **board** shows who's beaten and where to find the rest.

Frostspire Hollow. High in the cold heights is an ice cave where wild dragons train. Floor by floor a wild dragon comes out, each a little stronger, and every fifth floor is a checkpoint you can start from next time. The deeper you go, the colder it gets.

BEAUTY SHOWS



A show at Moonpetal Glade

At [Moonpetal Glade](#), a night garden of glowing flowers, dragons compete in themed [pageants](#). Each show has a theme that favours certain elements, colours and styles, so different dragons shine in different shows. There are three rounds, each scored by three judges:

- **Look:** a clean dragon, dressed for the theme in things that suit its colours.
- **Poise:** bond, manner and mood, and how well it's cared for.
- **Performance:** tap the tricks in time with the music. A strong bond widens the window.

Dress your dragon from the [wardrobe](#): hats, scarves and more, and dyes. Each show league (Ember to Starfire again) has four shows, whose themes change from day to day; win all four for the league's title. Your dragon keeps every [ribbon](#) it wins.

CHALLENGES

The notice board by the [Arena's](#) gate lists three challenges, each with four cups from Ember to Starfire. Win a cup to open the next.

- [Sky Rings](#): a race through a course of rings in the sky against rival dragons, riding your grown dragon. First to the last ring wins; every ring missed adds three seconds.
- [Fruit Catch](#): flick fruit up and away from the basket with the stylus (faster flicks throw further), and your dragon runs, leaps or dives to catch it. Eight throws; the golden pears count double. Young dragons play a gentler, hopping version.
- [The Lantern Trial](#): crystal lanterns light up one by one in a pattern, each with its chime. Then tap them in the same order, and your dragon breathes each alight. A wrong one costs a heart.

Any dragon can start at the Ember cups; the higher cups of each want an older dragon. A cup pays once a day (the first win pays most), and every go costs your dragon some Energy. Your best cups stand in the den as [trophies](#).

AND MORE

- **Fishing at Driftwood Cove**, on the lake's far shore: press **A** to cast, wait for the bobber to dip, strike, then keep the line in the band until it's in.
- **The Wanderings**: at the Wanderers' Trailhead, choose a juvenile or older dragon and set off, then close your 3DS and go for a walk. Your steps take it along, and every 400 steps it has a chance to sniff something out: Gleam, trinkets for its hoard, now and then something rarer. It comes home muddy and happy.
- **The Nesting Stone**: two grown dragons, a male and a female, who are happy and close to you, can settle at the Nesting Stone together, and the next day there's an egg. Its kind and colouring come from both parents, and sometimes a pair makes something new. A pair rests three days before nesting again. What comes of which pair is yours to find out.
- **The Dragondex (START)** fills in as you meet dragons. Find every colouring of a kind for a reward and a banner to hang in the den.

TIPS AND QUESTIONS

Does it save? The game saves on its own as you play, and when you quit from the system menu (START, *Save & quit*). A little egg in the corner means it's saving.

What happens while I'm away? Time goes on as your 3DS clock says: your dragon gets hungry, sleeps at night and grows. When you come back the game catches up (up to two weeks at most). It'll be glad to see you.

Can I change my 3DS clock? Turning it back does nothing harmful: the game just counts no time. Jumping it forward counts as time passing, no more than two weeks of it.

My dragon is sulking. Feed it, pet it and brush it. If it's upset, go gently, offer its favourite food and pet it until its heartglow lights.

It won't play or battle. It's probably tired: a sleep (at night, or a daytime nap) brings its Energy back.

There's no sound. Your 3DS needs its DSP firmware (see *Installing*).

The 3D. Slide it up for depth, or turn it off in the settings to save a little battery.

THE KEEPER'S ALMANAC: CARE BY THE NUMBERS

The pages from here on are for keepers who like to know exactly how things work: the numbers behind the game, straight from its code.

THE NEEDS, HOUR BY HOUR

Need	Fades each hour awake	Asleep	Notes
Belly	6	3	Its favourite food fills half again as much
Clean	1.2	1.2	A bath fills it at once; dust and mud show on the dragon
Play	4	1	Playful and Mischievous dragons lose it a quarter slower
Love	3	0.8	Shy dragons lose it a fifth slower
Energy	3	+12 at night, +10 napping	It naps by day below 25, until 70

Things that spend Energy: a beauty show 10, a battle 12, a challenge 18, and den games a little.

MOODS AND CARE STARS

- **Mood** is the average of Belly, Clean, Play and Love with the lowest counted twice, less up to 10 when Energy is under 20. **Joyful** at 80 and up, **Content** 60 and up, **Restless** 40 and up, **Sulky** below that.
- A dragon becomes **upset** after 24 hours sulky, or after 3 days without a visit.
- **Care stars**, each day: the average of its lowest need over the hours it spent at home. 65 and up earns three stars, 40 and up two, 20 and up one. A day without a visit earns one at most.
- **Walks**: every 100 m together, Play +3, Love +2 and Belly –1.5; a bond point every 150 m.
- **The Sanctuary**: needs fade at a tenth of the speed and never drop below 50; growing up pauses.

BREEDING

Both grown, one male and one female, each with **bond 300** or more (of 1,000), both **Content** or happier and living in the den, and neither nested in the last **3 days**. The egg comes the next day. It comes out in the rare colouring **1 time in 20**, 1 in 10 if a parent has the rare colouring, and twice as often again with an **Ancient Blood** parent.

THE WANDERINGS

A chance to find something every **400 steps** (30% more for grown dragons, and a quarter more again for Curious or Greedy ones and for Keen Nose). Each find is Gleam (5 to 25) about half the time, a trinket for the hoard most of the rest, and now and then a little hoard of someone else's (30 to 60 Gleam). Every 2,000 steps there's a small chance of a wild egg (3%, or 6% for a Lucky dragon), one a trip at most.

THE KEEPER'S ALMANAC: MANNERS AND TRAITS

MANNERS

Each manner nudges one stat up a point and one down, and makes a dragon behave like one of six temperaments.

Manner	Raises	Lowers	Behaves like	What else it does	Show Poise
Brave	Might	Wit	Brave	Explores and flutters	10.5
Shy	Wit	Might	Shy	Love fades a fifth slower; petting and brushing give double bond	4.5
Playful	Wing	Stamina	Playful	Play fades a quarter slower; loves games and zoomies	9
Proud	Breath	Wit	Proud	Poses and preens	15
Sleepy	Stamina	Wing	Sleepy	Sleep brings Energy back half again faster	6
Curious	Wit	Stamina	Curious	A quarter more Wanderings finds	9
Gentle	Stamina	Might	Sleepy	As Sleepy	13.5
Mischievous	Wing	Wit	Playful	As Playful	7.5
Greedy	Might	Breath	Curious	As Curious	6
Stubborn	Stamina	Wit	Proud	As Proud	7.5

TRAITS

A dragon has one or two traits (three on its rare colouring), from those its kind leans to. Rarer kinds reach the rare tier, and only the rare colouring reaches the legendary one. Each trait does one thing:

Trait	Tier	What it does
Swift	common	Flies 6% faster, in the valley and in Sky Rings
Sturdy	common	Games, challenges, battles and shows cost a quarter less Energy
Keen Nose	common	A quarter more chances to find something on the Wanderings
Tidy	common	Clean fades, and dust settles, 40% slower
Hearty Eater	common	Food fills its Belly a quarter more
Early Riser	common	From 7 am to noon, Play and Love fade half as fast
Night Owl	common	From 5 pm to 10 pm, Play and Love fade half as fast
Sure-Footed	common	One extra heart in the Lantern Trial
Cuddly	common	Petting and brushing build bond faster (+1 a stroke)
Sunbather	common	From 10 am to 4 pm, Love fades half as fast
Water-Lover	common	A bath also fills Play (+20) and Love (+10)
Chatty	common	Walks together build bond twice as fast
Quick Learner	uncommon	A fifth more experience from everything
Strong Wings	uncommon	Wingbeats and bursts cost a quarter less stamina; a longer race meter
Treasure Hunter	uncommon	Half again as much Gleam from the Wanderings
Brave Heart	uncommon	Moves that lower its stats fail half the time
Gentle Giant	uncommon	+6 Poise in shows
Warm-Blooded	uncommon	Frost moves do a quarter less damage to it
Cool-Headed	uncommon	Ember moves do a quarter less damage to it
Deep Sleeper	uncommon	Sleep and naps bring Energy back 30% faster
Showoff	uncommon	+6 Look in shows
Loyal	uncommon	Never upset by your being away
Skydancer	rare	Turns 15% tighter and sinks 20% slower on the glide

Ironhide	rare	Takes a tenth less damage in battles
Lucky	rare	Rare Wanderings finds (a little hoard, a wild egg) twice as likely
Songbird	rare	The show's Performance timing window a fifth wider
Elemental	rare	Breath moves of its own element hit 15% harder
Glowheart	rare	Its mood counts 5 points higher
Mossback	rare	Shows that favour Grove count it as a Grove dragon
Starborn	legendary	One more point in every stat
Ancient Blood	legendary	Its eggs come out in the rare colouring twice as often
Phoenix Heart	legendary	A sulk never turns into being upset
Moonlit	legendary	Every battle stat 10% higher from 8 pm to 6 am
Sunkissed	legendary	Every battle stat 10% higher from 9 am to 5 pm

THE KEEPER'S ALMANAC: BATTLES

THE ELEMENTS' CHART

The attacking move's element down the side, the defending dragon's element across the top: 2 is double damage, $\frac{1}{2}$ is half, a blank is normal. Against a dragon of two elements, both count (but never more than double or less than half). Body moves with no element always do normal damage.

	Ember	Grove	Stone	Gale	Tide	Frost	Lumen	Shade
Ember					$\frac{1}{2}$	2		
Grove				$\frac{1}{2}$	2			
Stone				2		$\frac{1}{2}$		
Gale		2	$\frac{1}{2}$					
Tide	2	$\frac{1}{2}$						
Frost	$\frac{1}{2}$		2					
Lumen								2
Shade							2	

HOW A HIT IS WORKED OUT

- **Damage:** the move's power $\div 100 \times$ the attacker's Might (body moves) or Breath (breath moves) $\times 0.85 \times$ the elements' chart, then a roll of 80% to 100%, and $\times 1.5$ on a critical hit.
- **Stat steps:** each step up adds a quarter (two steps: +50%); each step down divides by 1.25 (two: by 1.5). Up to two steps either way. Stoneskin's guard divides the damage taken the same way.
- **Hitting:** the move's accuracy, nudged by Wit (yours against theirs: from 70% to 112% of it) and by Wing (a quicker foe dodges a little more: from 85% to 106%). Stat moves on yourself always work.
- **Critical hits:** 2% plus $6\% \times$ its Wit $\div$ the foe's Wit, from 5% to 14%.
- **Who goes first:** a move that always strikes first (Quick Swoop), then the higher Wing; within 2% it's a coin toss.
- **Level:** every level adds 1.5% to each battle stat, and health another 2.5% of its first level's.

- **Stat points:** each stat is its kind's base (1 to 10, a point either way at hatching, one more all round on the rare colouring, the manner's nudge), plus up to 30 trained points from Frostspire Hollow's wild dragons (counted at half in battles), plus Starborn's point.
- **A long battle:** after 40 turns, the dragon with more of its health left wins.

EXPERIENCE AND LEVELS

A battle is worth $(20 + 10 \times \text{the foe's level})$ experience, $\times (1 + 0.12$ for each level the foe is above yours), between a quarter and 1.8 times as much; more for champions and wild dragons. A loss is worth a third; giving up, nothing. Challenges pay 20, 35, 55 or 80 (Ember to Starfire) for a paid win, and 4 for any other finished run. The experience to reach a level is $12 \times n^2 + 38 \times n$, where n is the level less one:

Level	5	10	15	20	25	30	35	42
Experience	344	1,314	2,884	5,054	7,824	11,194	15,164	21,730

THE KEEPER'S ALMANAC: MOVES

Every dragon learns the body and stat moves below, and the five moves of each of its elements, as it levels up. The four it battles with are chosen on its profile. Moves marked *tiring* can't be used two turns running; a heal works once a battle.

ANYONE'S MOVES

Move	Level	Power	Accuracy	What it does
Tackle	1	45	100	A running bump
Claw Swipe	3	50	95	A quick swipe of the claws
Roar	4		90	Lowers the foe's Might a step
Quick Swoop	5	40	100	Always strikes first
Tail Swipe	7	60	90	A sweep of the tail
Preen	8		100	Raises its Wit a step
Wing Buffet	11	60	95	A clap of both wings
Rest	14		100	Heals 35% of its health, once
Headbutt	16	75	85	Head down and charge
Flex	20		100	Raises its Might a step
Crushing Pounce	30	90	85	All its weight; tiring

EACH ELEMENT'S MOVES

At level 1 a first breath (power 45, accuracy 100); at 9 its own stat move; at 12 a stronger breath (65, 95); at 18 a body move of its element, powered by Might (70, 90); at 26 its great breath (90, 85, tiring).

Element	Level 1	Level 9	Level 12	Level 18	Level 26
Ember	Ember Spark	Kindle: its Breath up a step	Flame Breath	Blaze Claw	Inferno
Grove	Seed Spit	Mossy Mend: heals 30%, once	Spore Burst	Vine Lash	Bramble Storm
Stone	Grit Spray	Stoneskin: guard up a step	Sand Blast	Stone Slam	Rockfall
Gale	Gust	Tailwind: its Wing up two steps	Cyclone	Wing Cutter	Tempest
Tide	Bubble Spray	Drench: the foe's Breath down a step	Water Jet	Wave Crash	Tidal Surge
Frost	Frost Puff	Chill: the foe's Wing down a step	Icy Breath	Frost Fang	Blizzard
Lumen	Glimmer	Dazzle: the foe's Wit down a step	Radiant Beam	Sunflare Strike	Starburst
Shade	Dusk Puff	Shadow Veil: its Wit up two steps	Umbral Breath	Shadow Pounce	Eclipse

THE KEEPER'S ALMANAC: CHALLENGES AND SHOWS

THE CUPS AND WHAT THEY NEED

	Ember	Flame	Blaze	Starfire
Sky Rings	A grown dragon; beat 2 rivals	Ember won; beat 3	Flame won; beat 3	Blaze won; beat 3
Lantern Trial	Any dragon	Ember won	Flame won; juvenile or older	Blaze won; grown
Fruit Catch	Any dragon; 1,100 points	Ember won; 1,600	Flame won, juvenile or older; 2,050	Blaze won, grown; 2,400

Younger dragons play Fruit Catch's hopping version for 800, 1,150 and 1,500 points. In Sky Rings, every ring missed adds three seconds, and the race ends at two and a half times the course's par.

Lantern Trial	Lanterns	Rounds	Pattern	Hearts	Each lantern lit for
Ember	4	4	2 to 5	3	0.85 s
Flame	5	5	3 to 7	3	0.72 s
Blaze	6	5	4 to 8	2	0.6 s
Starfire	6	6	5 to 10	2	0.5 s

Gleam	Ember	Flame	Blaze	Starfire
A cup's first win	80	140	220	350
A win again (once a day)	30	45	65	90
Placing (while the day's prize is still to win)	10	15	20	30

HOW SHOWS ARE JUDGED

Three judges score each round out of 100; the most points over the three rounds wins.

- Look:** clean (20), dressed for the theme (25: 8 for each thing worn that has one of the theme's styles, 2 for others), its colours in the theme's (15), what it wears suiting its colours (10, or 3 wearing nothing), how rare its kind is

(common 4, harder to find 7, rare 10, and 2 more for the rare colouring), and its element (18 if the theme favours its first element, 11 its second). Showoff adds 6.

- **Poise:** bond (35, growing fast at first), manner (up to 15: see the manners' table), mood (Upset 0, Sulky 4, Restless 10, Content 19, Joyful 25) and care (25, full at 30 care stars). Gentle Giant adds 6.
- **Performance:** tap each cue in time. A perfect tap is within 0.075 seconds, a good one within 0.17; a strong bond widens both by up to 60% (Songbird by a fifth more). Longer streaks score more.

Theme	Favours	Styles
Frost Ball	Frost, Tide, Lumen	Frosty, Elegant
Harvest Fair	Grove, Stone	Floral, Wild
Starlight Gala	Lumen, Shade, Gale	Starry, Elegant
Ember Carnival	Ember, Stone	Fiery, Festive
Tide Regatta	Tide, Gale	Cute, Festive
Blossom Festival	Grove, Lumen	Floral, Cute
Shadow Masquerade	Shade, Ember	Elegant, Wild
Sunrise Parade	Ember, Lumen, Gale	Starry, Fiery

Gleam	Ember	Flame	Blaze	Starfire
A show's first win	50	90	140	220
A win again (once a day)	20	30	45	60
Second / third place	12 / 6	18 / 10	25 / 14	35 / 20
Winning the league	100	200	350	500

CREDITS AND LICENCES

Emberclutch: Skyreach Valley was made by [Noah Hicks](#), with Claude (Anthropic) writing much of the code and tools. Inspired by Emi.

- Code: MIT licence. Original art and assets: CC BY-SA 4.0. Music and generated sound effects: their own terms. See the repository for the full credits and licences.
- Fonts: Nunito and Cinzel Decorative (renamed in the game), under the SIL Open Font License.
- Built with devkitPro, libctru, citro2d and citro3d.

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